

Pop the Bubble — Hacker Pack

Issue 01 · 5–7 June 2026 · London · 36 hours · 80 builders

Everything you need to build, ship, and win. Read it once before you arrive, keep it open during the weekend. Questions → tag an organiser in Discord.

TL;DR

- **When:** Fri 5 June (evening) → Sun 7 June 2026. **36 hours** of build time (8pm Fri → 8am Sun).
- **Where:** London. Exact venue sent to accepted builders by email + Discord.
- **Teams:** Solo or up to **4 people**.
- **Prize:** **£10,000** first place + in-kind prizes for 2nd/3rd (accelerator interviews, credits, hiring pipelines).
- **Judged on:** Real-world evidence — money earned, customers talked to, burdens removed.
Show the receipts.
- **Post as you build:** sharing your progress publicly earns **bonus points**.
- **Discord:** <https://discord.gg/xZPfWvykd> — mission control. Turn notifications on.

1. Key Info & Contacts

Dates	Friday 5 – Sunday 7 June 2026
Build window	8:00pm Fri → 8:00am Sun (36h)
Venue	London — full address in your acceptance email + pinned in Discord
Awards reception	Sun 7 June, 11:30–15:00, St Katharine Cree — drinks, networking, livestreamed
Wifi	SSID + password on signage & pinned in Discord on arrival
Discord	https://discord.gg/xZPfWvykd — primary comms
Email	contact@hackhouse.uk
Emergency / on-site	Organiser numbers shared at check-in

2. Schedule (Run of Show)

Friday 5 June — Day 1

- **5:00pm** — Doors open · check-in · arrival + mingling
- **6:20–7:00pm** — Opening talk + sponsor talks + Q&A (tracks & judging explained)
- **7:00pm** — **Dinner** · Zia Pina spread — pasta salad (side) + beef bresaola & grilled-veg platters (mains). Halal + veg options.
- **8:00pm** — **Hacking officially begins** 🕒 (your 36h clock starts)
- Team up early (solo? find people during arrival / **#team-formation**)
- Build through the night — couches around the venue if you need to crash (see §12)

Saturday 6 June — Day 2

- **8:00am** — 🏠 **Milestone 1** — post your progress (Discord + socials, see §5)
- **9:00am** — **Breakfast** · Tongue & Brisket sandwich platters (Reuben, roast beef, vegan) + coffee
- **Lunch** — light / leftovers (intentional — go talk to users, don't queue)
- **5:30pm** — **Dinner** · icco pizza (Marinara, Funghi, Margherita — all Halal) + fresh Red Bull
- **8:00pm** — 🏠 **Milestone 2** — post your progress
- All-night push 🌙

Sunday 7 June — Day 3

- **8:00am** — 🏠 **Milestone 3 = CODE FREEZE**. Final submission in (see §7).
- **~9:00am** — Everyone out — the building flips to another event.
- **8–11am** — Judges score submissions remotely. **Rest, shower, brunch — you've earned it.** (Sunday chill-spot recs pinned in Discord — the City's shut, head to Spitalfields / Brick Lane.)
- **By 11am** — Top 3 teams called up to demo live. Everyone else: come celebrate.
- **11:30am–3:00pm** — **Awards Reception @ St Katharine Cree**
 - Top 3 live demos → winners announced
 - 🍷 Wine + coffee · networking with builders, founders & invited guests · livestreamed
 - Optional, but you'll want to be there — it's the party.
- Closing dinner — top 3 teams + sponsors

Exact code-freeze and demo timings are confirmed in Discord during the event. **Watch the announcements channel.**

3. The Three Tracks

Pick **one**. Your track frames how you're judged. The through-line for all three: **do real work for the real world, and get paid.**

01 · Outbuild

Find a slow, bloated, or half-built product — even tools you use daily have broken corners (yes, even Luma). Ship the sharper version, ideally **open source**, and go get **real users and actual paychecks**.

Example: Pick a product with obvious gaps. Rebuild the part that's broken, open-source it, and pull over as many real (ideally paying) users as you can in 36 hours.

What wins: clearly better than the incumbent · real users switched · ideally revenue.

02 · Validate

Build the evidence pack against a company and **show where the story doesn't hold** — where claims, numbers, or reality don't line up. Rigorous, credible, data-backed.

Example: Take a company making claims that don't add up. Build the dashboard / report / analysis that exposes the gap — and makes the truth impossible to ignore.

What wins: rigour and credibility · the significance of the truth you surface · proof a decision-maker can't argue with.

03 · Effect

Find one real person or organisation and **remove a recurring burden *with* them — not *for* them**. Hackers can genuinely transform someone's week. Stale industries and businesses that barely use their own software (let alone AI) will benefit enormously. Then **get paid**.

Example: Find a real person, or a business in a stale industry, drowning in a repetitive burden. Sit with them, build the thing that removes it — keeping them in the loop — and get paid for it. A local business, a solo professional, anyone whose life you can visibly change.

What wins: a real burden visibly removed for a *named* person/org · money changed hands · genuine collaboration *with* them.

4. Rules

- **Team size:** 1–4 people.
 - **You own everything.** All IP — code, product, brand — stays 100% with your team. We take no cut, no equity, no licence, no rights. The only thing we ask is opt-in: you may choose to be on a post-event shortlist sponsors can contact. That's your call.
 - **Be honest — this is the big one.** Don't fake traction, demos, revenue, or conversations. Every number you claim, you show. We'd rather see one real paying customer than a hundred imaginary ones. Inflated or fabricated proof = disqualified.
 - **Code of conduct applies** (§14) — in the venue, in Discord, and on socials.
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5. Milestones & Building in Public

The hack runs on **12-hour milestones**. At each one, do two things:

1. **Post your progress in Discord** (your team thread) — keeps you on pace and lets mentors + judges see your momentum.
2. **Post publicly** — LinkedIn, X, a quick edited reel, whatever. Show what you're building.

Milestone	When	Drop
🏠 M1	Sat 8:00am	12h in — what's working so far
🏠 M2	Sat 8:00pm	24h in — traction / first users
🏠 M3	Sun 8:00am	Final submission (see §7)

📢 **Posting earns bonus points — seriously, post.**

We *want* you building in public. Post **however you like, as often as you like** — threads, demos, reels, before/after, "we just got our first paying customer" moments. It gets you publicity, users, and feedback while you build — and it earns you **bonus points with the judges**. **Tag us on every post** so it counts toward your bonus and we can amplify you — **Aruzhan first** (most likely to see and reshare), then the rest of the organisers, then the sponsor accounts.

Tag us:

- 📷 Instagram: **@popthebubble.hack**
- 🐦 X: [@arukanism](#) (Aruzhan) · [@zmzlois](#) (Lois) · [@Lantos1618](#) (Lyndon) · [@dimplnotsimp](#) (Alramina)
- 💼 LinkedIn: [Aruzhan](#) · [Lyndon](#) · [Lois](#) · [Alramina](#)

- More good posts → more points.
 - Real moments > polished marketing.
 - This is free distribution for your product. Use it.
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6. Judging Criteria

We judge on **evidence, not promises**. Every team is scored against a shared baseline, then on what matters most for *your* track.

Baseline (all tracks)

- **Does it actually work?** Live, real, demonstrable — not a mockup.
- **Depth of proof.** Show the receipts (see Submission, §7).
- **Honesty.** Real numbers only.

Track-specific weighting

Track	What we weight most
Outbuild	How much <i>better</i> than the incumbent · real users switched over · revenue / paychecks earned
Validate	Rigour & credibility of the evidence · how significant the truth you exposed is · would it hold up to scrutiny
Effect	Realness of the burden removed for a <i>named</i> person/org · money earned · the " <i>with</i> them" collaboration, not "for" them

★ Bonus points

- **Build in public** — posting your progress during the hack (§5).
 - **Mubit SDK** — teams that *meaningfully* use the Mubit SDK (operational memory for AI agents) earn bonus points. A perk that lifts your score across the rubric — **not** a separate prize category. Docs + keys in **#sponsor-mubit**.
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7. Submission & Demo

Submit by the Sun 8:00am code freeze (form pinned in Discord). Late = not judged.

Your submission:

- Team name + members
- Track
- One-line pitch
- **Live URL + repo + demo video**

- **Proof — as much as you can stack up.** This is what wins:
 - Revenue / paychecks — invoices, Stripe screenshots, the actual accounting
 - Customer evidence — emails, call recordings or notes, signed LOIs, signups
 - Traction — user counts, usage data, before/after numbers
 - Anything real. **Show us the receipts.**
- **Slides (optional):** welcome — but *not* to pitch or LARP your product. Use them only to **show what you built and the traction you have.** Evidence, not a sales deck.

Top 3 demo live at the awards reception. Show the working thing and your proof.

8. Prizes

- 🥇 **1st place — £10,000 cash**
- 🥈 **2nd place — in-kind stack:** speedtracked accelerator interviews (Residency, EWOR + others), sponsor product credits, sponsor hiring-pipeline access.
- 🥉 **3rd place — in-kind stack:** accelerator interviews + credits + pipeline access.
- + **Sponsor credits & perks** for all builders (see §9).

The in-kind prizes are deliberately high-leverage: an accelerator fast-track and direct sponsor pipelines beat a runner-up cheque for a serious builder.

9. Founding Sponsors

The companies backing the builders. Each has a Discord channel — that's where their tools, keys, and team live.

Founding Sponsor	What they bring	Channel
Mubit	Operational-memory SDK for AI agents — bonus points for using it. Keys + docs + support.	#sponsor-mubit
Cognition	Their own product + tooling for builders.	#sponsor-cognition
AccelerateMe	Mentorship + pipeline.	#sponsor-accelerateme
Standard Manufacturing Co.	Founding sponsor.	#announcements
Zuba	Founding sponsor.	#announcements

Credits & API keys (Vercel + others) drop in **#perks-and-credits** during the event — check it Friday night. *Sponsors: send your logo, credit codes, and SDK quick-start to finalise this table.*

10. Getting Help

There's no fixed "office hours" slot — help is **always on**.

- **Post in #help** with what you're stuck on and what you've already tried.
- **Tag a mentor or sponsor** in their Discord channel — they'll jump in.
- **Find them on the premises** — mentors and sponsor engineers are around all weekend. Walk up and ask.

11. Food

All meals below are covered. Here's **exactly** what you get, so you know what to expect:

When	What
Fri 7:00pm — Dinner	Zia Pina: pasta salad (side) + beef bresaola & grilled-veg platters (mains)
Sat 9:00am — Breakfast	Tongue & Brisket sandwich platters (Reuben / roast beef / vegan) + coffee
Sat — Lunch	Light / leftovers (on purpose — go talk to users)
Sat 5:30pm — Dinner	icco pizza (Marinara / Funghi / Margherita, all Halal) + fresh Red Bull
Throughout	Red Bull (regular + sugar-free) + coffee — help yourself; topped up Sat evening

What we do *not* provide (plan accordingly):

- No Friday breakfast/lunch (doors open 5pm).
- Saturday lunch is **light leftovers**, not a fresh hot meal.
- No catered breakfast Sunday at the venue — you're out by 9am; grab brunch at the recommended spots. Wine + coffee at the reception.

Dietary: Halal options at every meal; vegetarian & vegan options available. Allergen info on request. **Flag dietary needs in your acceptance reply** if you haven't. Bring a water bottle.

12. Travelling In & Staying Over

Coming from another city or country? Read this.

- **There's no dedicated sleep room** — but the venue is large with plenty of couches to crash on.
 - **Bring a sleeping bag** (or invest in a good one) — especially if you don't have anywhere else to stay overnight. This is the single most important thing for out-of-towners.
 - Bring an **eye mask, toiletries, and a change of clothes** — it's a 36-hour event and you'll feel human for the Sunday reception.
 - The building runs **cold at night** — pack layers.
 - **Nearest stations / travel:** shared with the venue address to accepted builders. London is well-connected; plan your Friday arrival for ~4:30–5pm and your Sunday onward travel for after 3pm if you're staying for awards.
 - On a budget? Coordinate with other out-of-towners in Discord (**#general**) to split accommodation or share the venue overnight.
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13. What to Bring

- 🖥️ Laptop + **charger** (and a multi-plug if you have one)
 - 🔌 Your own **dongle/adaptor** for the demo screen (HDMI + USB-C available; bring a clicker if you like)
 - 🪪 ID for check-in
 - 🛏️ **Sleeping bag** if you're staying overnight (see §12)
 - 🧥 Layers — it gets cold at 3am
 - 🪥 Overnight kit (toothbrush, deodorant, eye mask, change of clothes)
 - 🎧 Headphones for deep focus
 - 💧 Water bottle
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14. Code of Conduct

Pop the Bubble is built on respect, generosity, and good-faith building. This applies **everywhere** the event lives — the venue, Discord, the awards reception, and anything you post under the event's name.

We expect you to:

- Treat everyone — builders, organisers, mentors, sponsors, venue staff, guests — with respect, regardless of background, identity, or experience level.
- Be generous: share knowledge, help when asked, lift others up.
- Build honestly. No faked work, traction, or proof (see §4).

- Respect the venue and equipment. Clean up after yourself. It's not yours.
- Respect people's focus, sleep, and consent — including for photos and filming (we film the event; tell an organiser if you'd rather not be on camera).

We will not tolerate:

- Harassment, discrimination, intimidation, or hate speech of any kind — including in DMs and on socials.
- Unwelcome sexual attention or contact.
- Sustained disruption, bullying, or deliberate sabotage of other teams.
- Plagiarism or passing off others' work as your own.
- Bringing weapons, illegal substances, or anything that endangers others.

Reporting: if something's wrong, tell **any organiser in person** or **DM a mod in Discord**. We take every report seriously and will keep it confidential.

Consequences: organisers may issue a warning, remove you from the event or Discord, disqualify your team, or involve venue security — without refund of any perks — depending on severity. Organisers' decisions are final.

The short version: **be excellent to each other, and don't be the reason we have to write more rules.**

15. FAQ

Can I start building before the event? Prep all you want — plan, research, build context, line up warm leads, talk to your target customer. That's encouraged. But the **execution happens during the 36 hours**. A little pre-building is fine; the bar is simple: **the work you do during the hack must be so substantial that no one can deny it**. If the weekend's progress is the obvious heart of the project, you're good.

Do I keep my IP? 100%. It's entirely yours.

Can I join solo and find a team there? Yes — Friday's arrival window is for exactly this. Start early in **#team-formation**.

Is there somewhere to sleep? No dedicated rest zone, but the building's big and there are plenty of couches. **Bring a sleeping bag** (§12).

What if I get stuck? Post in **#help**, tag a mentor/sponsor in Discord, or find them on-site (§10).

How do I win? Real evidence of impact against your track — money, users, burdens removed. Plus build in public for bonus points. Not promises.

16. Stay Connected

- **Discord:** <https://discord.gg/xZPfWvykd> ← live nerve centre
- **Apply / RSVP:** <https://lu.ma/035ubxn3>
- **Demo Day:** <https://luma.com/bi8t9jh8>
- **Instagram:** [@popthebubble.hack](#) — tag us in your build-in-public posts
- **Email:** contact@hackhouse.uk

See you in the room. Go pop something. 🍉